asked him what it was, he said, 'You'll get to know very soon.'

l. Why was the attic 'a favourite place' for the children?

m. What did Aditya do on reaching the attic?

We next went to a jeweller's to find out the weight of the article. The jeweller remarked that it was an antique. Our next stop was the house of Jogesh Kabiraj. Though I was a little curious, I didn't ask Aditya anything.

We entered the house and went to the room where Sasanka Sanyal stayed. Sasanka *uncle* was busy reciting verses from Tagore. When he had finished, Aditya asked, 'May we come in?'
He turned and faced us.



'No one visits me,' he said in an unperturbed manner.

'Would you mind if we come in?'

'Come in.'

Except for a *charpoy* there was nothing else to sit on, so we remained standing.

'Do you remember Aditya Narayan Chowdhury?' Aditya asked him.

'Of course,' said the gentleman. ''The spoilt child of affluent parents! Was a fairly good student but could never beat me. He was extremely jealous of me. And he used to tell lies.'

'I know,' said Aditya. He then took out a packet from his pocket and handing it over to him, said, 'This is for you, from Aditya.'

n. What did the jeweller say about the article?

o. Was Sanyal happy about his visitors?

'What is it?' he asked.

'Money'.

'Money?How much money?'

'One hundred and fifty rupees. He has said that he will be happy if you accept it.'

'Shall I laugh or cry? Aditya has given me money! Why this sudden generosity?'

'Man does change with time. Perhaps Aditya is not the same Aditya as before?'

'A change? I got the prize. He could not bear it. He took it from me to show his father and never returned it to me. Said that there was a hole in his pocket and it had fallen through it.'

'This is the price of the medal. It is yours.'

Sasanka Sanyal was amazed. He stared at Aditya and said, 'The price of the medal? That could not be more than five rupees. It was a silver medal.'

'Silver is now thirty times costlier than before.'



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